

WORLD WAR II AND THE RAILWAYS

Hitler invaded Poland on 1 September 1939 and, in retaliation, the Allied forces of Britain and France declared war on Germany two days later. What started out as a European war might have stayed that way, but for France and Britain's colonial acquisitions around the world, Germany's military pact with Italy, itself an owner of colonies, and Japan, a powerful player in the East. All of the British Empire's available resources were mobilized, including the railways in India.